

INFO 492 — INTENSIVE CAPSTONE

AI-Assisted RFI Review

Checking Information Before Submission

Team: Team 8 — Subcontractor Perspective

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Research Background: Making RFIs Clearer

- Unclear questions and missing context can lead to requests for more information.
- Procore recommends clear questions and relevant background information.
- Existing Procore AI tools help draft RFIs and find related project information.
- Our research asks whether an AI check before submission can reduce the GC's first-review time.

Footer citations: Medina & Tell (2025); Procore (n.d.).

Our Thesis: Check Before Submission

Proposed target: Reduce median GC first-review time by at least **25%**, without increasing information errors.

- Compare the same RFI form completed with and without AI assistance.
- The agent checks missing context, unclear questions, and document references.
- The subcontractor verifies the suggestions and approves the final submission.

Our Dataset: Dett Elementary School (Chicago)

A new one-story annex and renovation of an existing school, finished in 2024

A public project, so all six addenda with RFIs and answers are online.

Real questions from contractors and real answers from the architect.

Each addendum shows which drawings were changed, which gives us a correct answer for testing.

Preparing the Data

- 01** Each RFI becomes one row in a CSV file with the question, answer, drawings, and problem type.

- 02** We also build a list of drawing numbers, so the agent can check if a reference exists.

- 03** These RFIs are from the bid stage, so we rewrite them as subcontractor-to-GC RFIs.

- 04** Every rewritten RFI is labeled as simulated and linked to the original.

Four Demo Concepts

- 01 Find missing details:** remove information like location or deadline, and test if the agent notices.

- 02 Check references:** test if the agent catches wrong drawing references, such as a keynote that pointed to detail 6/A-703 instead of 1/A-703.

- 03 Improve the draft:** the agent makes unclear questions more specific, and the subcontractor approves the final version.

- 04 Send to the GC:** the GC team reviews RFIs with and without AI, and we record review time, errors, and clarification requests.